

1.2 Arcade Games And The Early 1980s

The early '80s saw the advent of arcade games. These coin-operated machines were generally programmed to play one game and were customised accordingly. Mostly found in places such as fast food joints, arcade games were huge hits. The controls in an arcade game were very basic and consisted of joysticks or push buttons.

The so called 'Golden Age' of arcade games reached its peak in the early '80s. During this time, a number of new genres were established, and many new innovations in graphics technology were taking place.



Eye-catching arcade machines were custom designed for games

Games such as *Defender*, released in 1980, were among this crop of genre definers. The game was revolutionary in many respects—it was the first to show actions other than those initiated by the player and it took place outside the player's view.

Games such as *Pole Position* used pseudo-3D graphics, and were the first to use the 'rear-view racer format'. This style became the norm in most racing games, and is still used as an option in games such as *Need for Speed*.

Computer gaming didn't happen until 1982 when two machines were released specifically for gaming—the Commodore 64 and the ZX Spectrum. Initially, the low image-processing quality and graphics capabilities of computers limited the types of games released for home computers. These limitations gave rise to text-